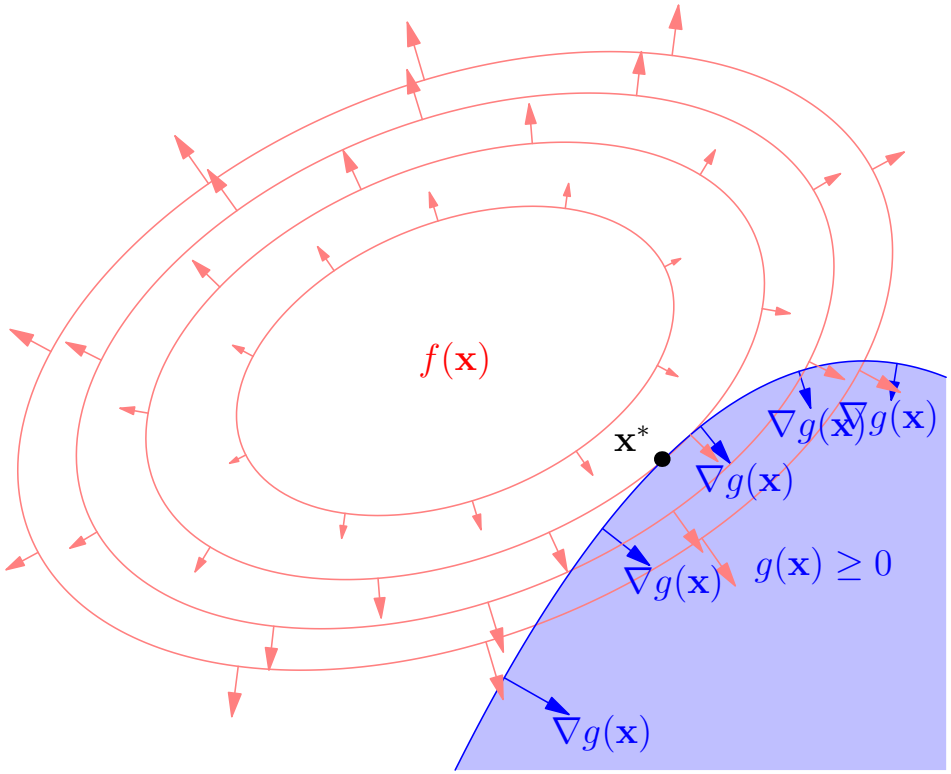
Mathematics of Machine Learning

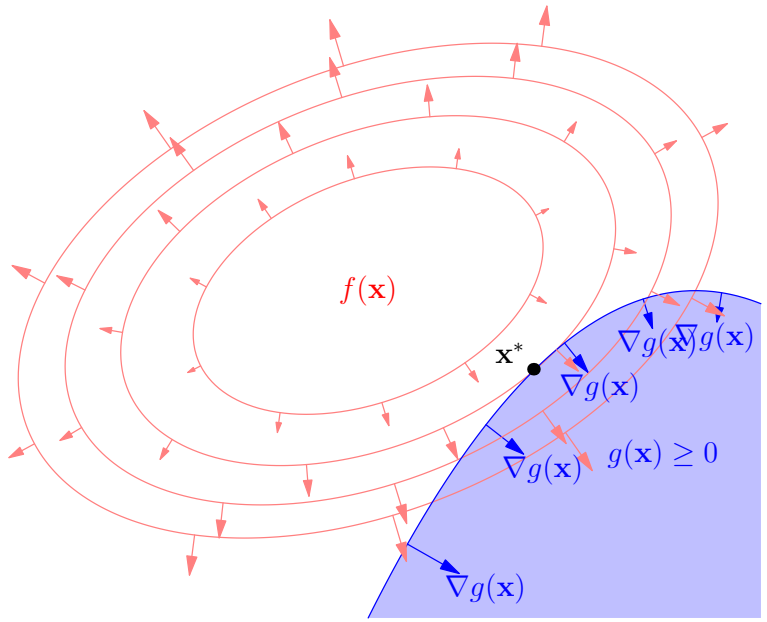
Constrained Optimisation



Lagrangians, Inequalities, KKT, Linear Programming, Quadratic Programming, Duality

Outline

1. **Constrained Optimisation**
2. Inequalities
3. Duality



Optimisation with Constraints

- There are a number of important applications where we wish to minimise an objective function subject to inequality constraints
- A prominent example of this is support vector machines
- More generally there are a large number of kernel models that involve constraints
- However, constraints are ubiquitous in machine learning (e.g. in Wasserstein GANs)

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Solving Constrained Optimisation Problems

- Suppose we have a problem

$$\min_{\boldsymbol{x}} f(\boldsymbol{x}) \quad \text{subject to } g(\boldsymbol{x}) = 0$$

- A standard procedure is to define the Lagrangian

$$\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{x}, \alpha) = f(\boldsymbol{x}) - \alpha g(\boldsymbol{x})$$

  where α is known as a Lagrange multiplier

- In the extended space $(\boldsymbol{x}, \alpha)$ we have to solve

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- But what about first condition: $\boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\boldsymbol{x}} f(\boldsymbol{x}) = \alpha\boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\boldsymbol{x}} g(\boldsymbol{x})$?

Note on Gradients

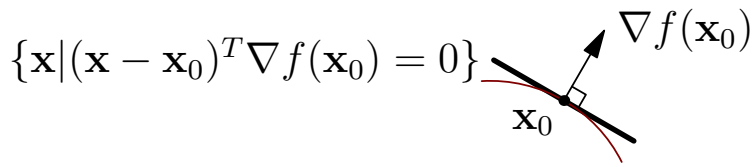
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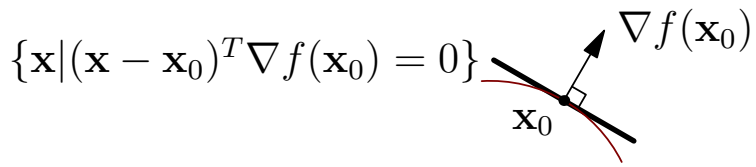
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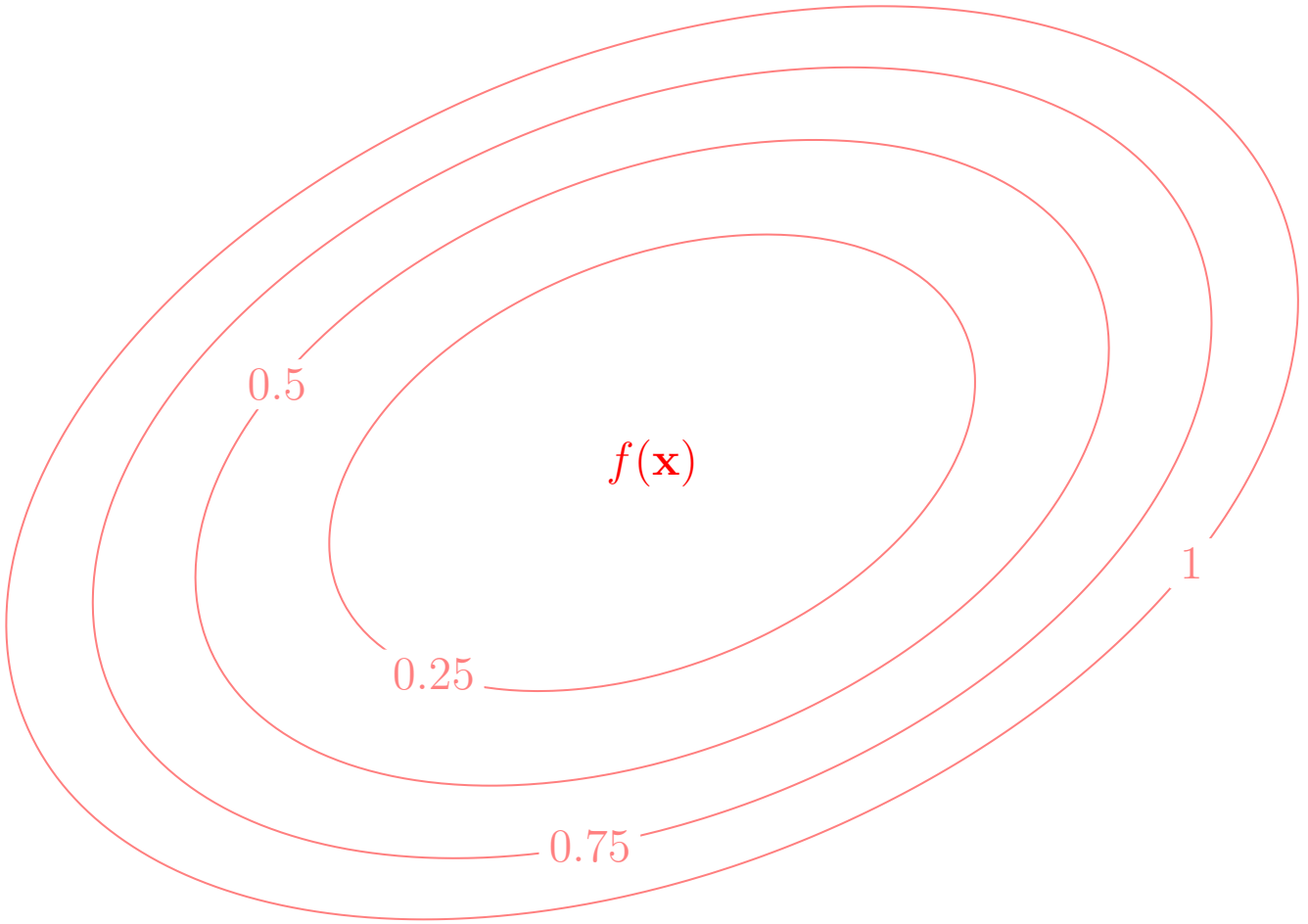
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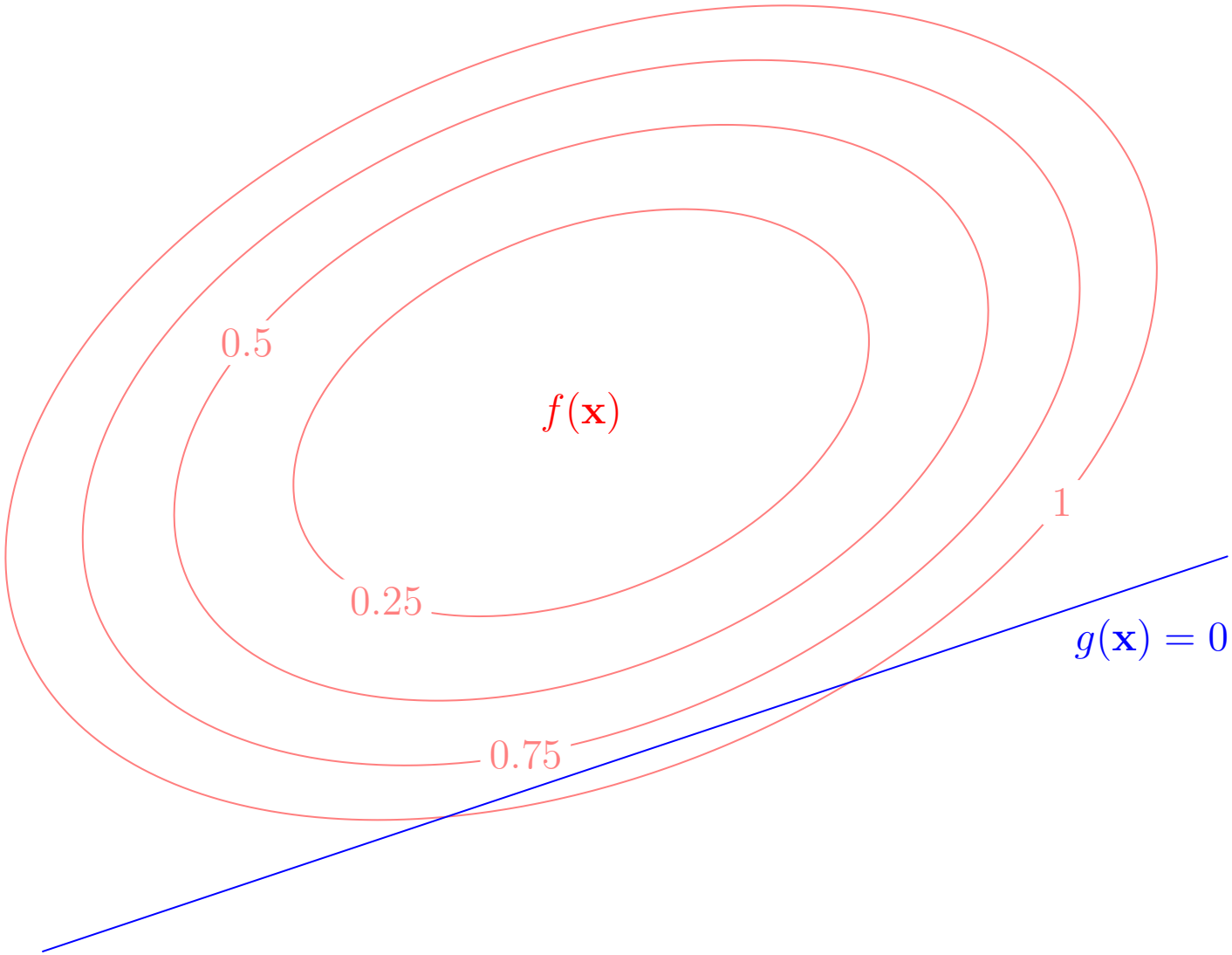


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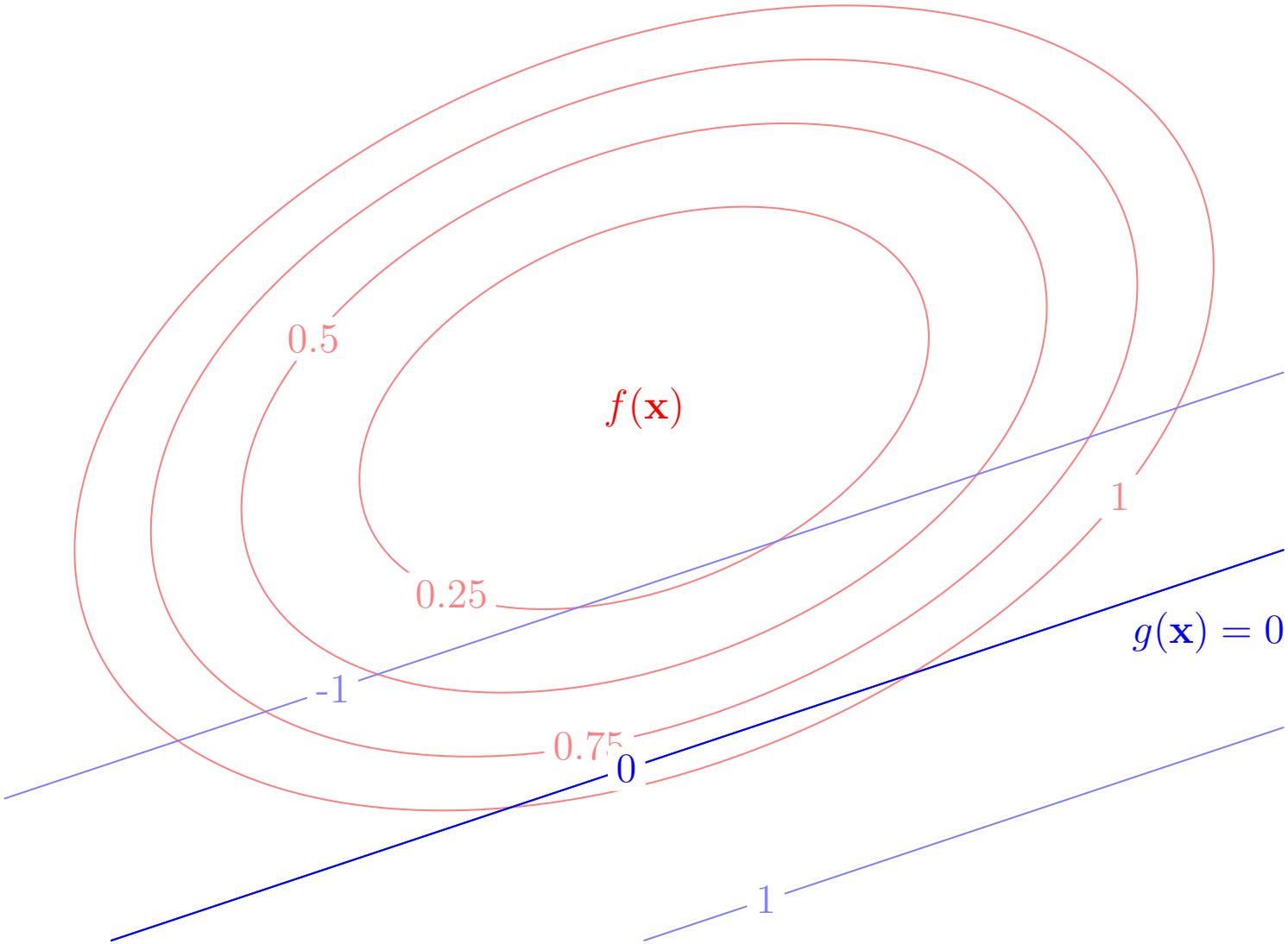
Constrained Optima



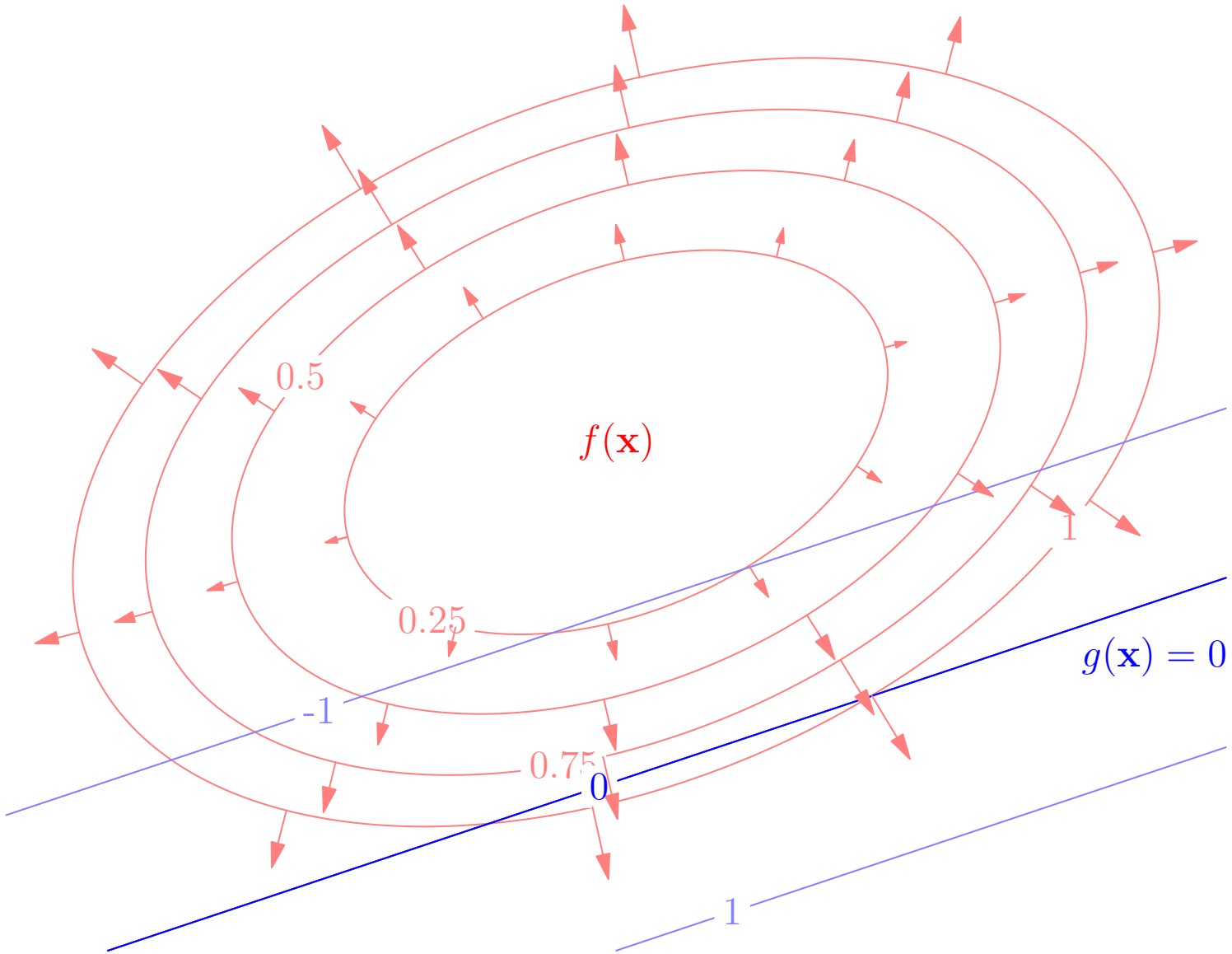
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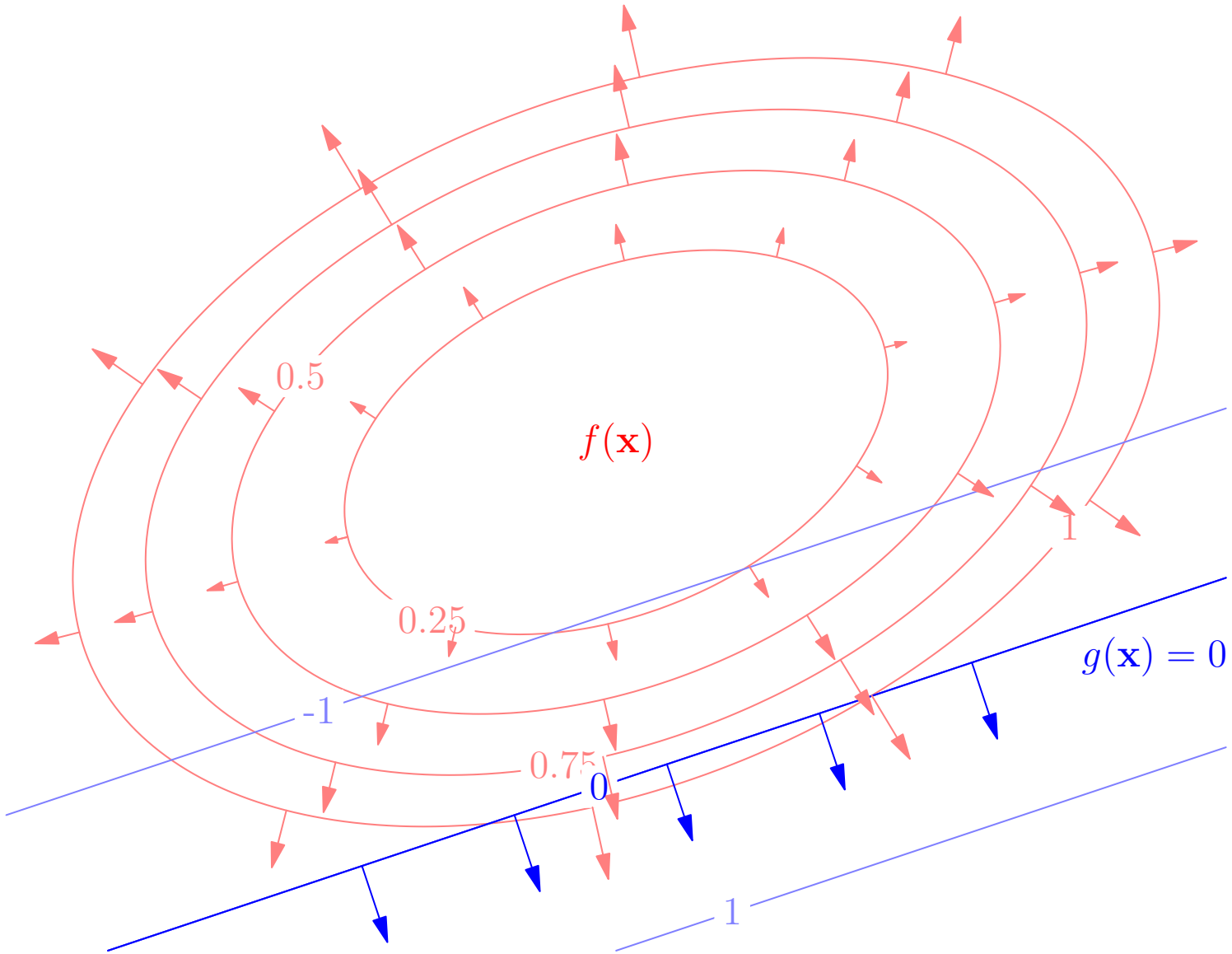
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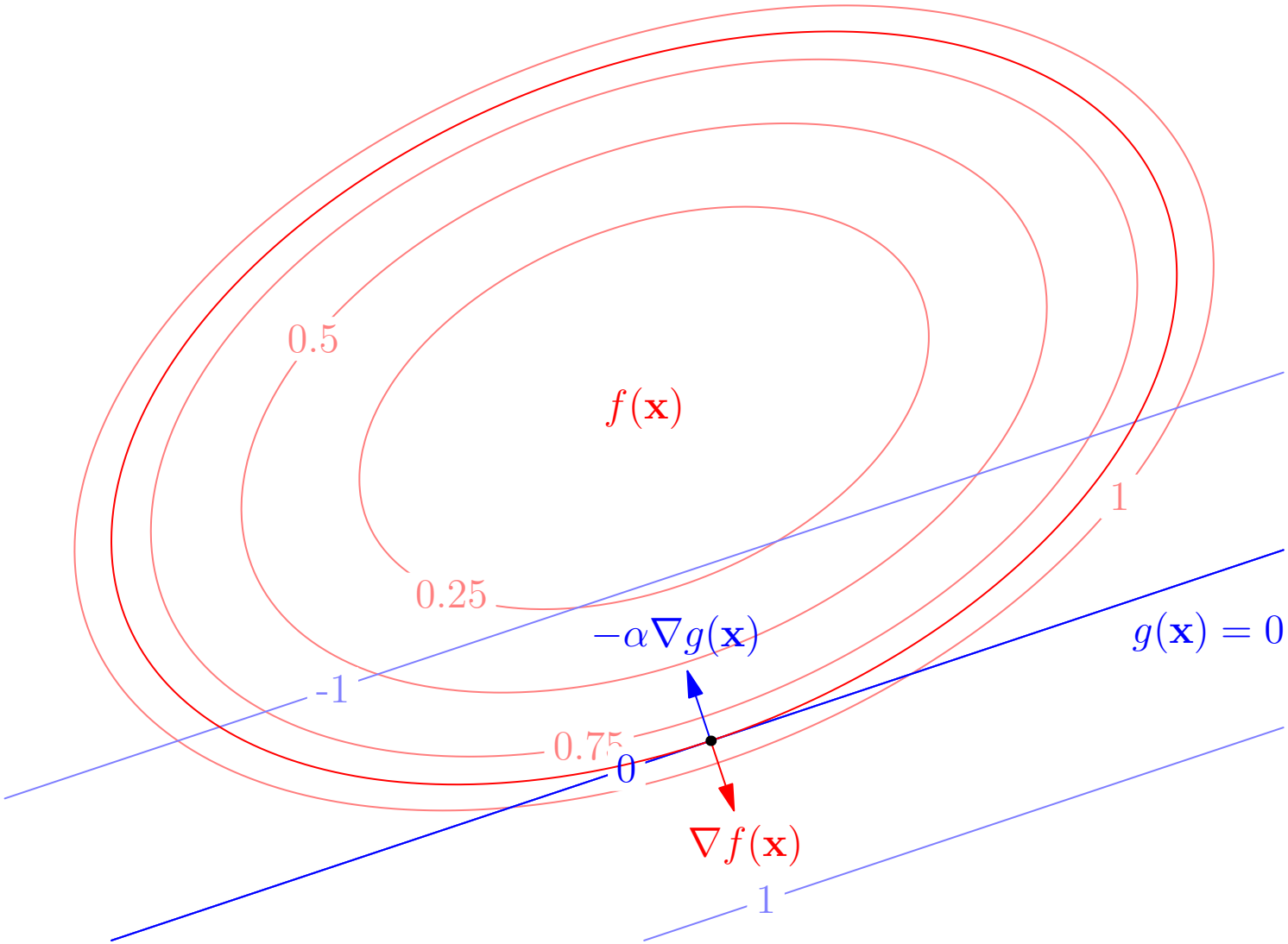
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Example

- Minimise $f(\boldsymbol{x}) = x^2 + 2y^2 - xy$
- Subject to $g(\boldsymbol{x}) = x - 2y - 3 = 0$
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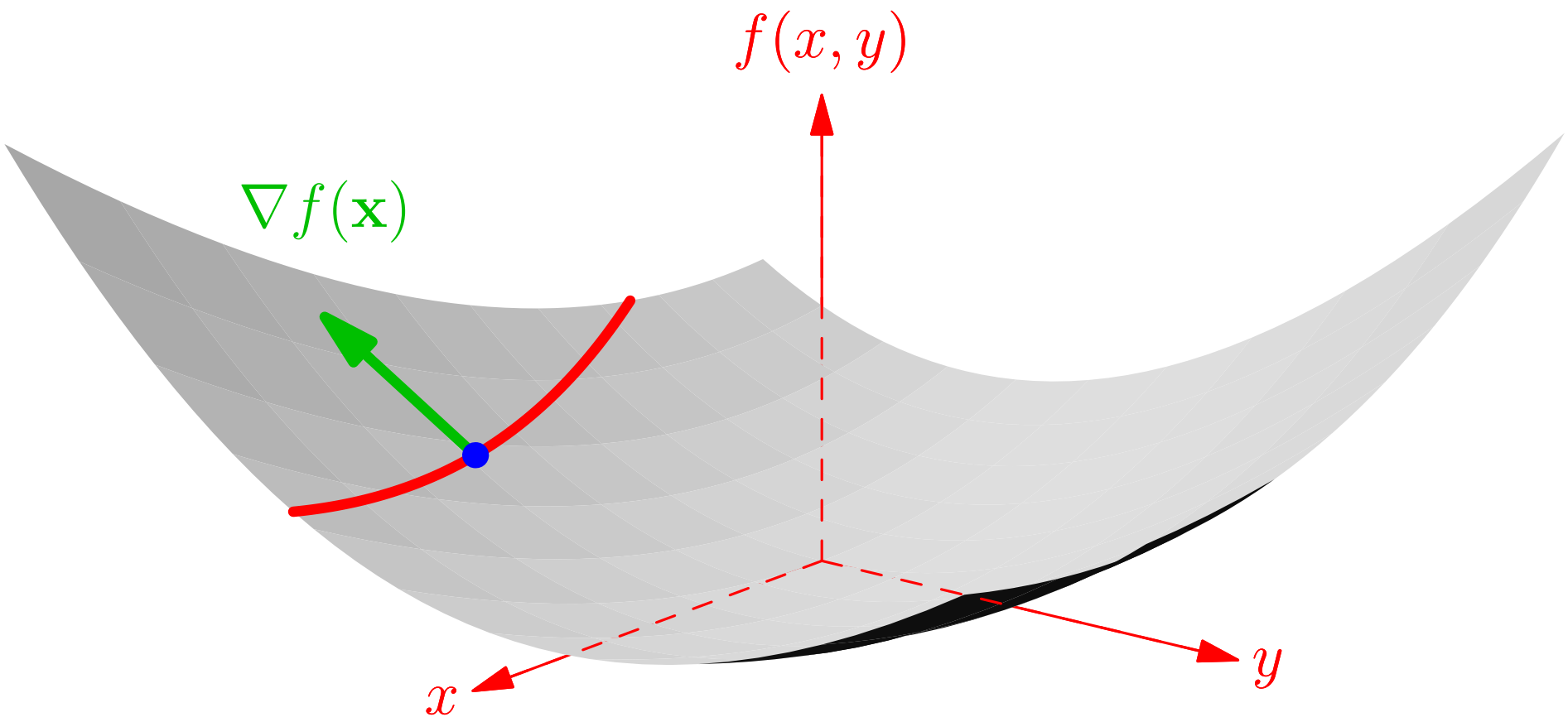
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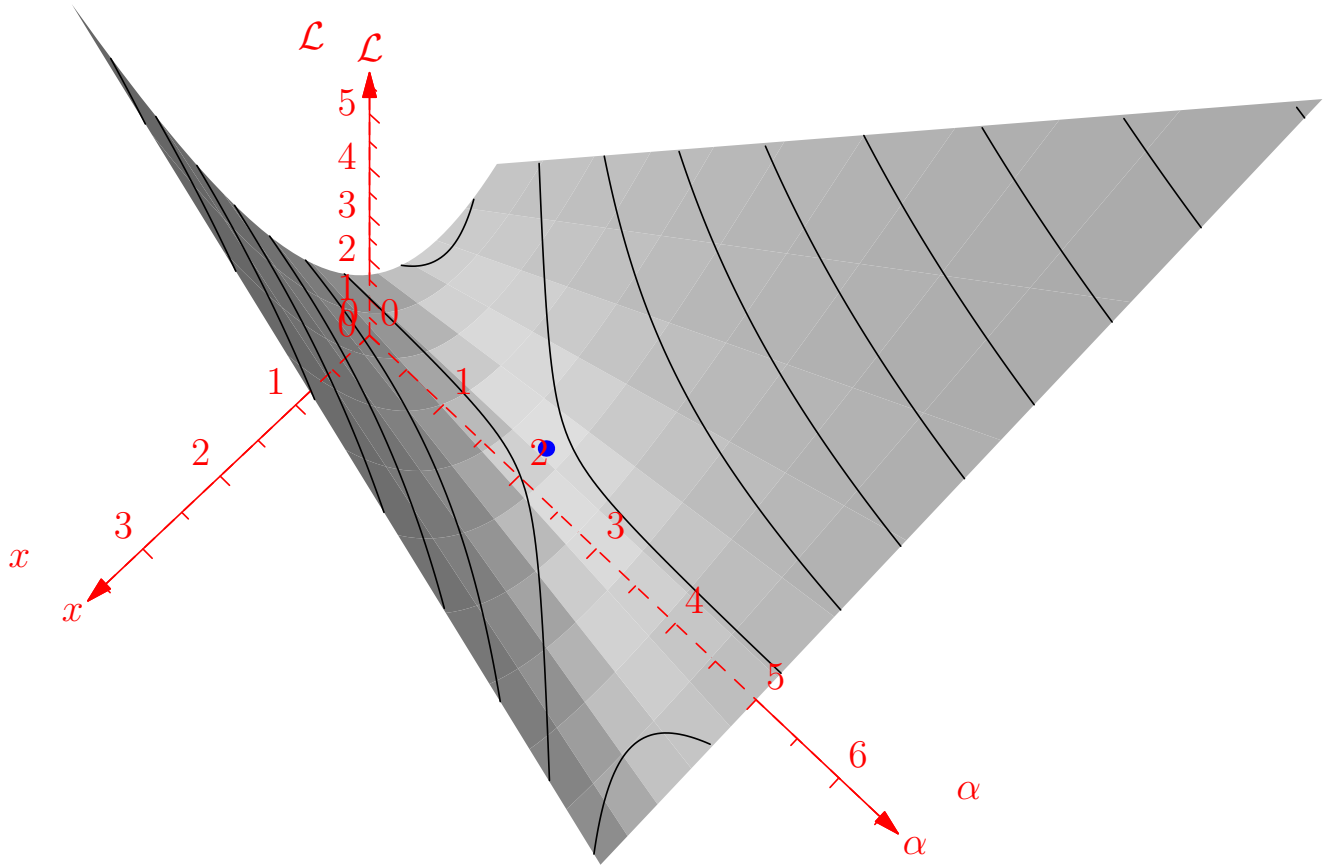
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Surface



Saddle-Point $y = -9/8$



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- Given an optimisation problem with multiple constraints

$$\min_{\boldsymbol{x}} f(\boldsymbol{x}) \quad \text{subject to } g_k(\boldsymbol{x}) = 0 \text{ for } k = 1, 2, \ldots, m$$

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- Minimise $f(\boldsymbol{x}) = x^2 + 2y^2 + 5z^2 - xy - xz$ subject to $g_1(\boldsymbol{x}) = x - 2y - z - 3 = 0$ and $g_2(\boldsymbol{x}) = 2x + 3y + z - 2 = 0$
- Writing $\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{x},\boldsymbol{\alpha}) = f(\boldsymbol{x}) - \alpha_1 g_1(\boldsymbol{x}) - \alpha_2 g_2(\boldsymbol{x})$
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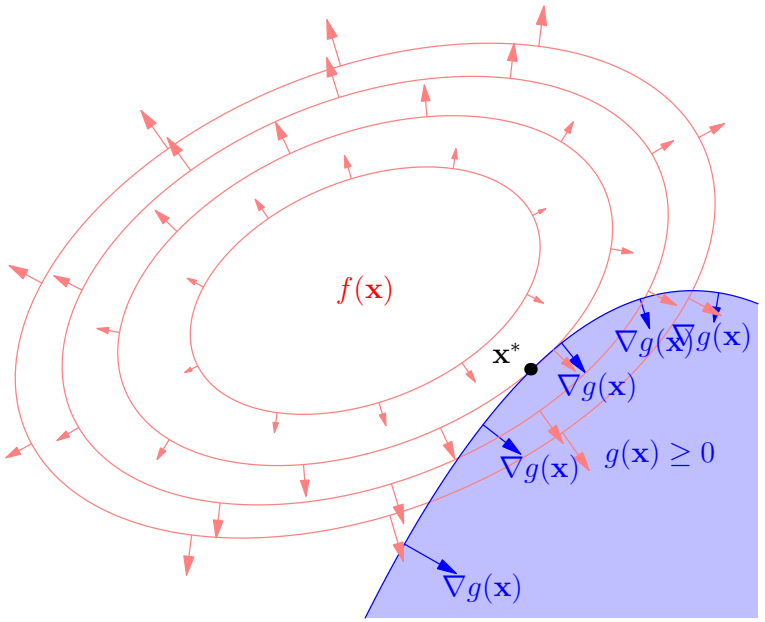
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Outline

1. Constrained Optimisation
2. **Inequalities**
3. Duality



Inequality Constraints

- Suppose we have the problem

$$\min_{\boldsymbol{x}} f(\boldsymbol{x}) \quad \text{subject to } g(\boldsymbol{x}) \geq 0$$

- Looks much more complicated, but

- Only two things can happen
  - ⋆ Either a minimum, $\boldsymbol{x}^*$, of $f(\boldsymbol{x})$ satisfies $g(\boldsymbol{x}^*) > 0$
    - ∗ We then have an unconstrained optimisation problem
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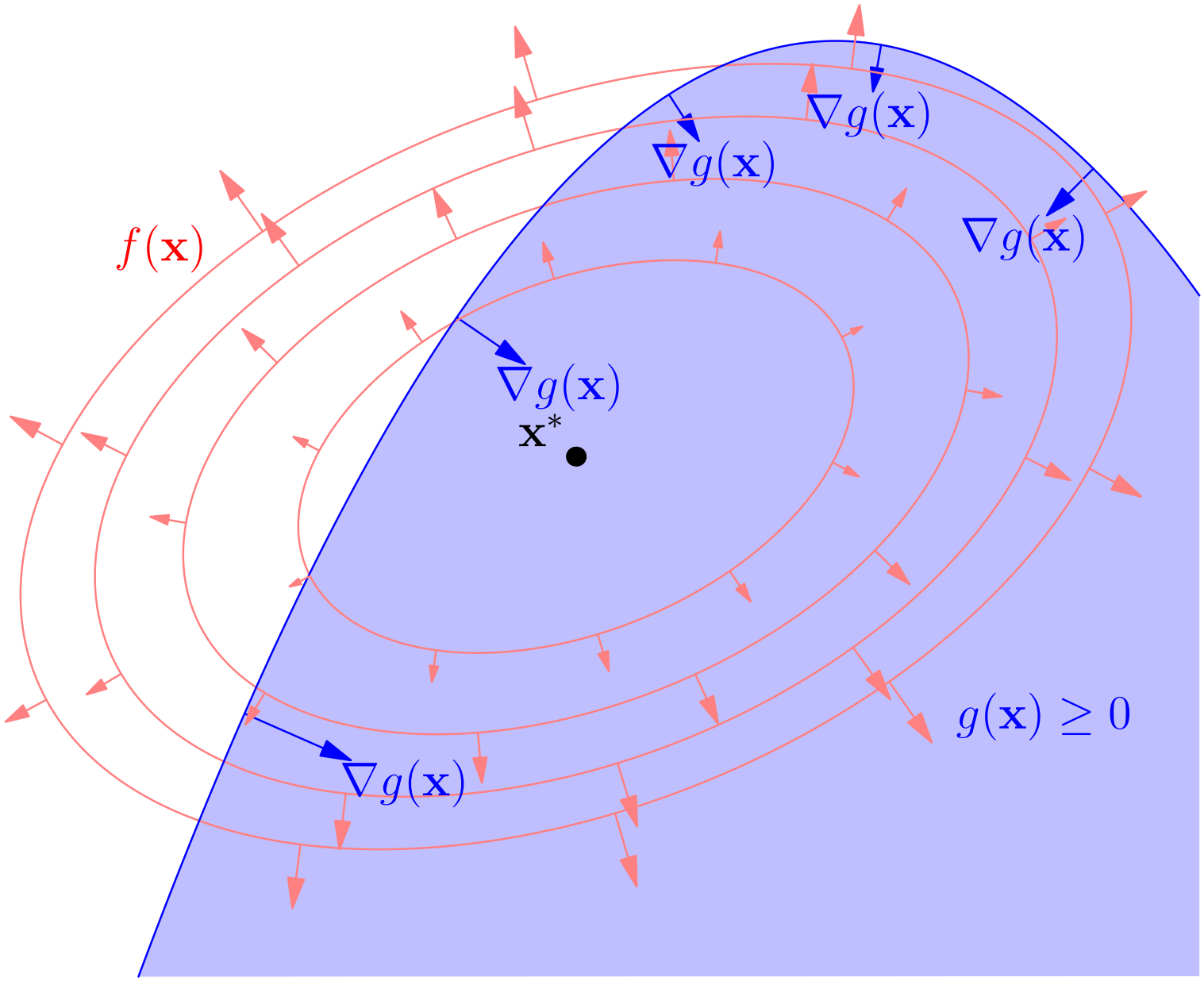
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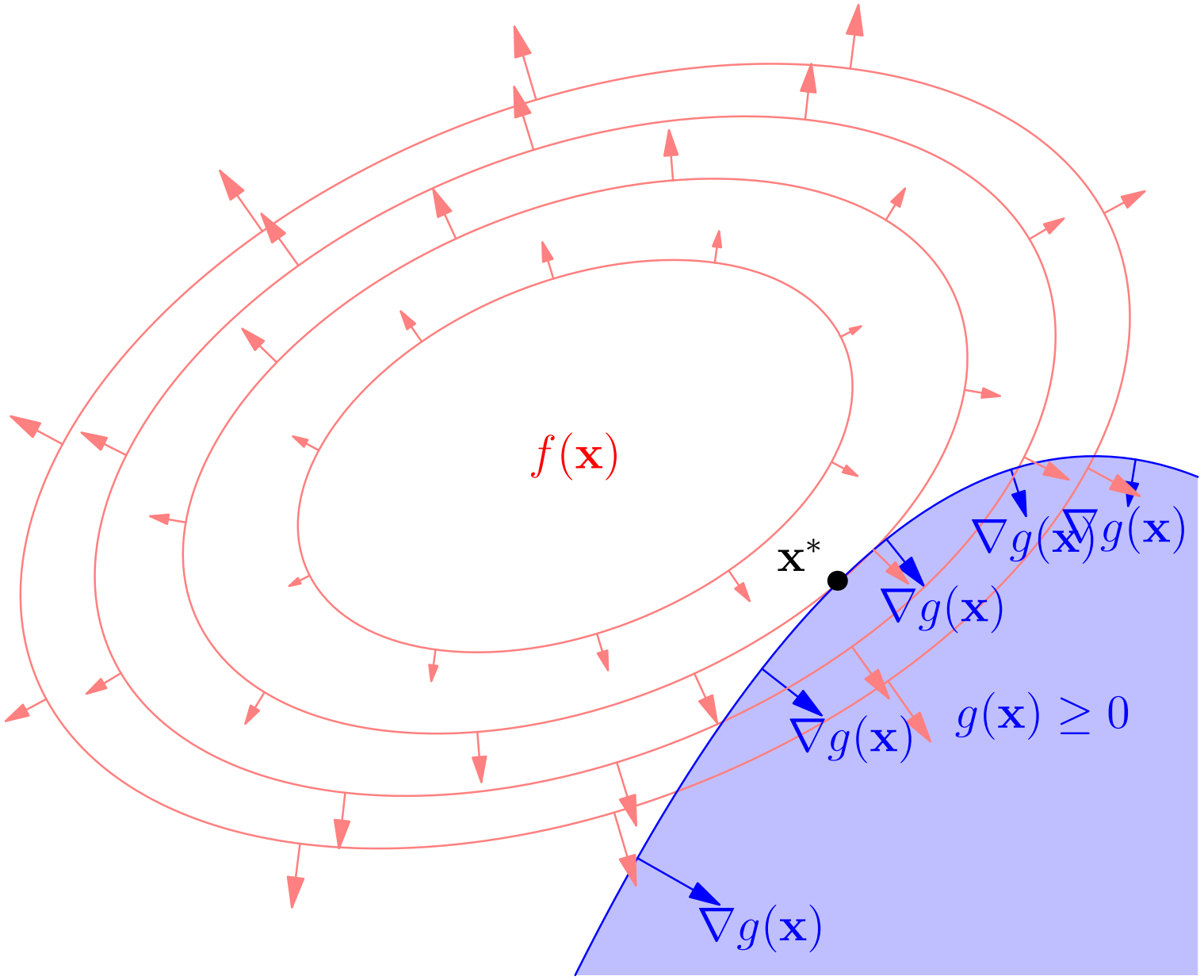
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  - ⋆ Either a minimum, $\boldsymbol{x}^*$, of $f(\boldsymbol{x})$ satisfies $g(\boldsymbol{x}^*) > 0$
    - ∗ We then have an unconstrained optimisation problem
  - ⋆ Otherwise, it satisfies $g(\boldsymbol{x}^*) = 0$
    - ∗ We have a constrained optimisation problem

Inside Region



On the Boundary



KKT Conditions

- To minimise $f(\boldsymbol{x})$ subject to $g(\boldsymbol{x}) \geq 0$

$$\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{x}, \alpha) = f(\boldsymbol{x}) - \alpha g(\boldsymbol{x})$$

- Then $\boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\boldsymbol{x}} \mathcal{L} = 0$ or

$$\boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\boldsymbol{x}} \mathcal{L} = \boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\boldsymbol{x}} f(\boldsymbol{x}) - \alpha \boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\boldsymbol{x}} g(\boldsymbol{x}) = 0$$

- with $\alpha \geq 0$ and $\alpha g(\boldsymbol{x}) = 0$: either $\alpha = 0$ (the constraint plays no part) or $\alpha > 0$ and $g(\boldsymbol{x}) = 0$ (the solution is on the boundary)
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Many Inequalities

- Given the problem

$$\min_{\boldsymbol{x}} f(\boldsymbol{x}) \quad \text{subject to } g_k(\boldsymbol{x}) \geq 0 \text{ for } k = 1, 2, \ldots, m$$

- We introduce multiple Lagrange multipliers

$$\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{x}, \boldsymbol{\alpha}) = f(\boldsymbol{x}) - \sum_{k=1}^{m} \alpha_k g_k(\boldsymbol{x})$$

- The condition for an optimum is

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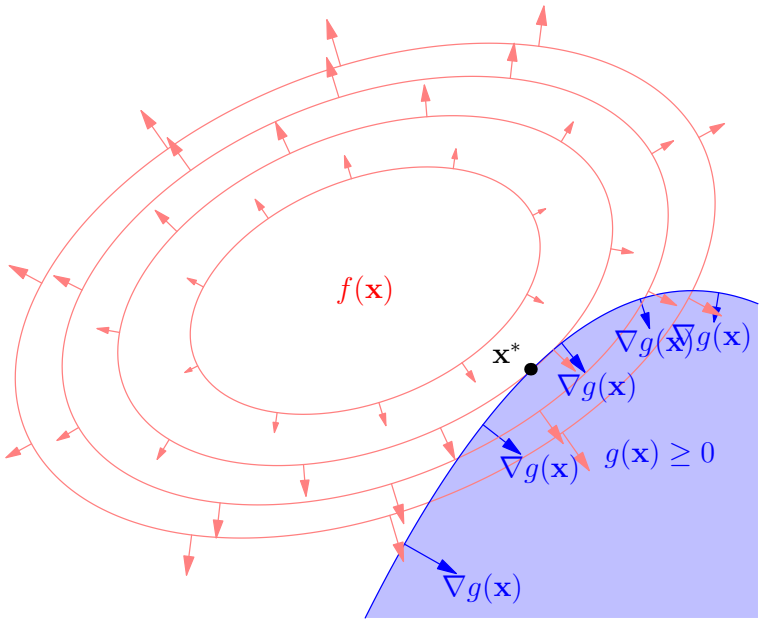
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Outline

1. Constrained Optimisation
2. Inequalities
3. **Duality**



Solving the Lagrangian for x

- Consider minimising a function $f(\boldsymbol{x})$ subject to a set of constraints $g_i(\boldsymbol{x}) = 0$ or $g_i(\boldsymbol{x}) \geq 0$

- We can consider this a double optimisation problem

$$\max_{\boldsymbol{\alpha}} \min_{\boldsymbol{x}} \mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{x}, \boldsymbol{\alpha}) = \max_{\boldsymbol{\alpha}} \min_{\boldsymbol{x}} \left(f(\boldsymbol{x}) - \sum_i \alpha_i g_i(\boldsymbol{x}) \right)$$

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Dual Problem

- If $f(\boldsymbol{x})$ and $g_i(\boldsymbol{x})$ are simple we can sometimes find a set of variables $\boldsymbol{x}^*(\boldsymbol{\alpha})$ that minimises the Lagrangian

$$\boldsymbol{\nabla}_{\boldsymbol{x}}\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{x}^*(\boldsymbol{\alpha}),\boldsymbol{\alpha}) = 0$$

- This leaves us with the **dual problem**

$$\max_{\boldsymbol{\alpha}} \mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{x}^*(\boldsymbol{\alpha}),\boldsymbol{\alpha})$$

- If we had an inequality constraint $g_i(\boldsymbol{x}) \geq 0$ then we would have the additional constraint in the dual problem $\alpha_i \geq 0$

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- In linear programming we minimise a linear objective function $\boldsymbol{c}^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{x}$ subject to linear constraints $\boldsymbol{g}(\boldsymbol{x}) = \mathbf{M}\boldsymbol{x} - \boldsymbol{b} = 0$ (or $\boldsymbol{g}(\boldsymbol{x}) \geq \mathbf{0}$ with $\boldsymbol{x} \geq \mathbf{0}$)

- The Lagrangian becomes

$$\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{x},\boldsymbol{\alpha}) = \boldsymbol{c}^{\mathsf{T}}\boldsymbol{x} - \boldsymbol{\alpha}^{\mathsf{T}}(\mathbf{M}\boldsymbol{x} - \boldsymbol{b})$$

- An equivalent way of writing the Lagrangian is

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Linear Programming Example

- Suppose we eat potatoes and rice and we want to ensure that we get enough vitamin A and C

	Potatoes	Rice	Daily Requirement
Vitamin A	3	5	20
Vitamin C	5	2	24
Price	5	4	

- We want to buy P kg potatoes and R kg of rice as cheaply as possible subject to fulfilling our vitamin requirement

$$\min_{P,R} 5P + 4R$$

subject to $P, R \geq 0, \quad 3P + 5R \geq 20$ and $5P + 2R \geq 24$

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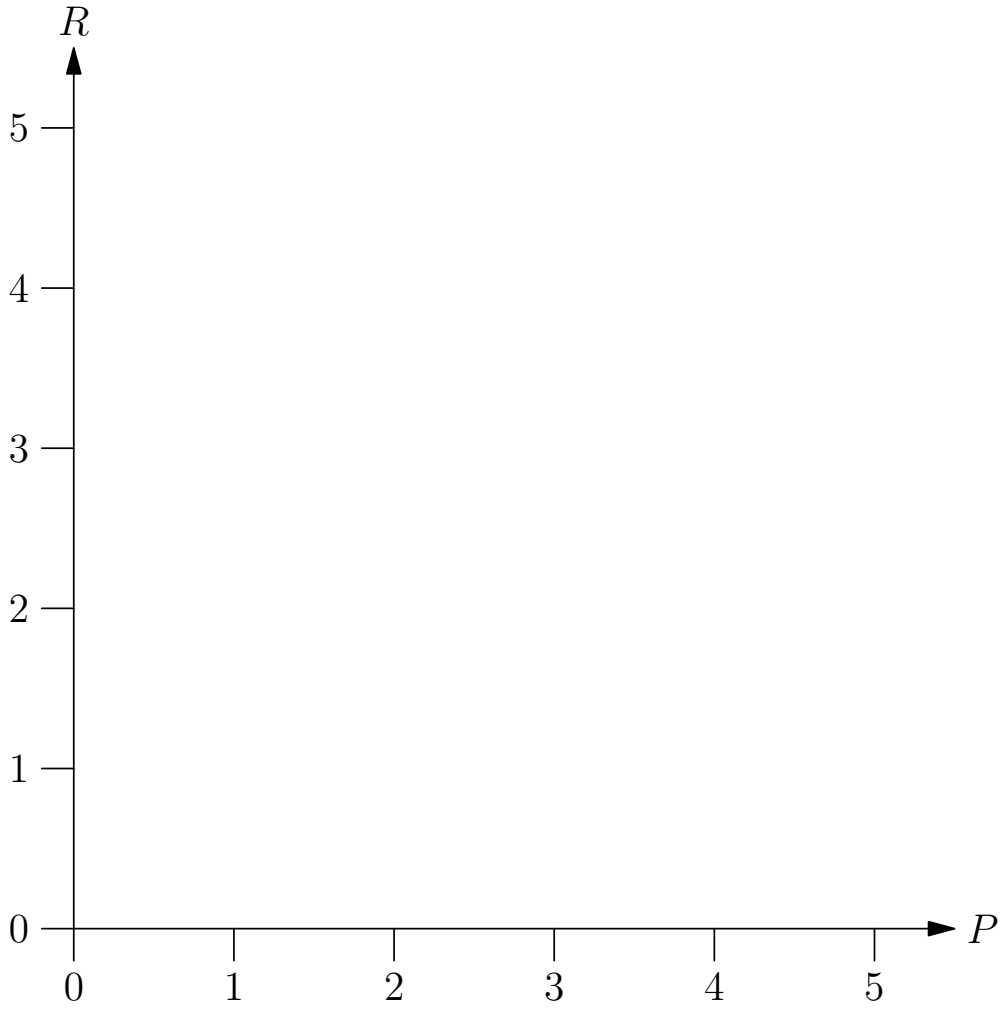
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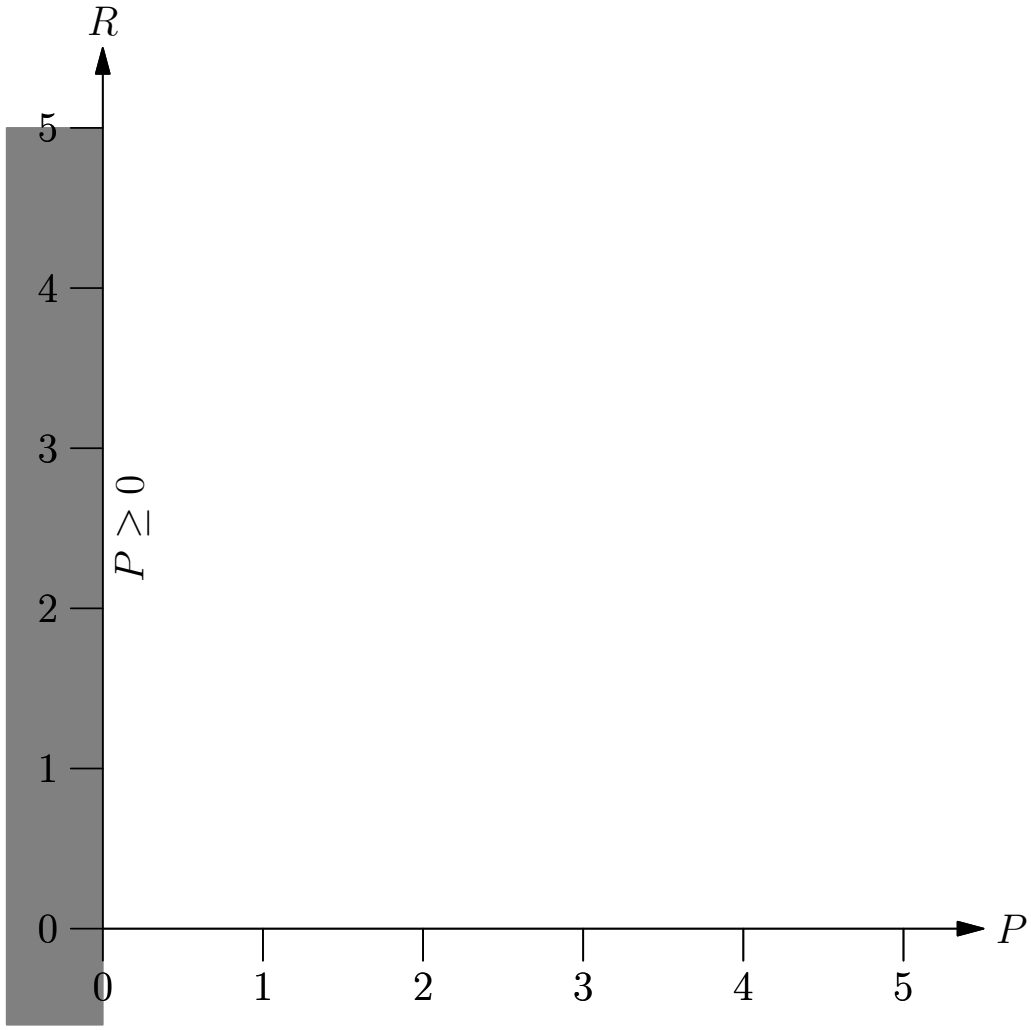
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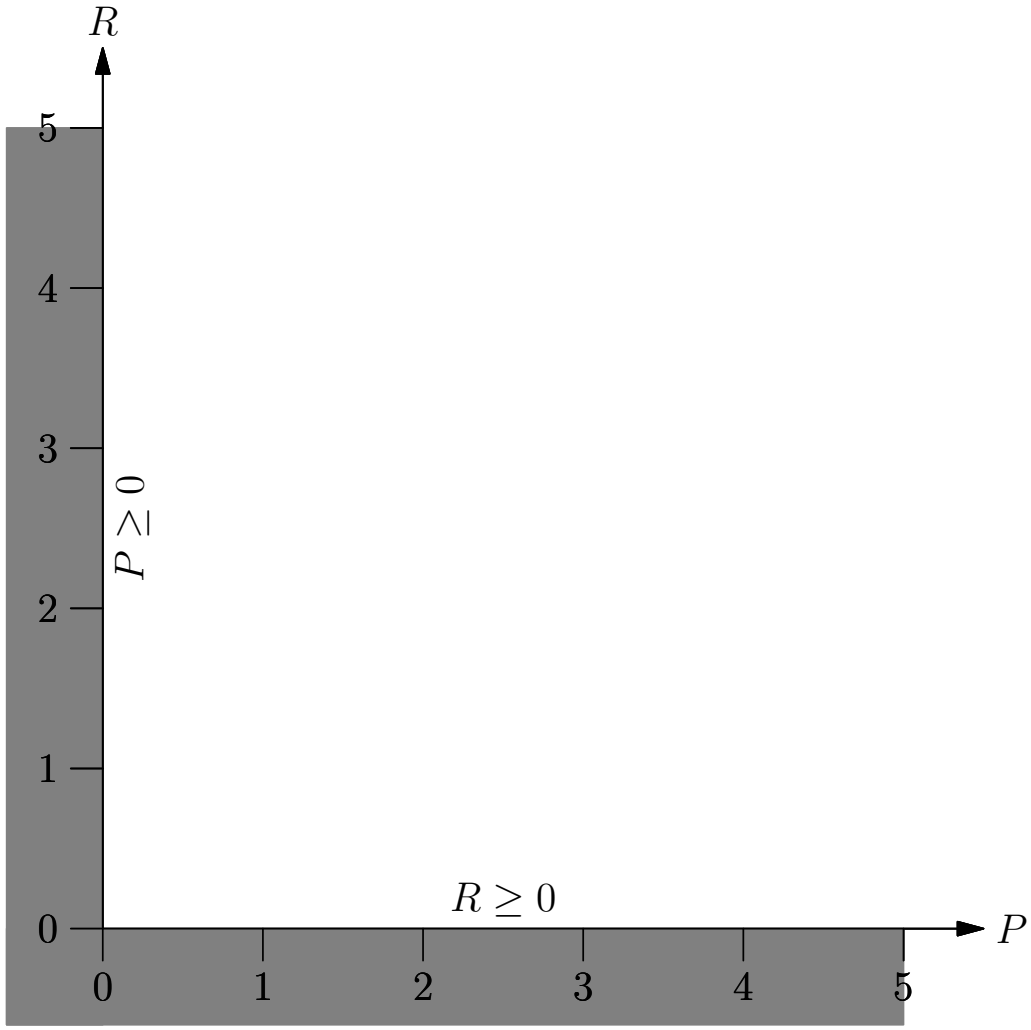
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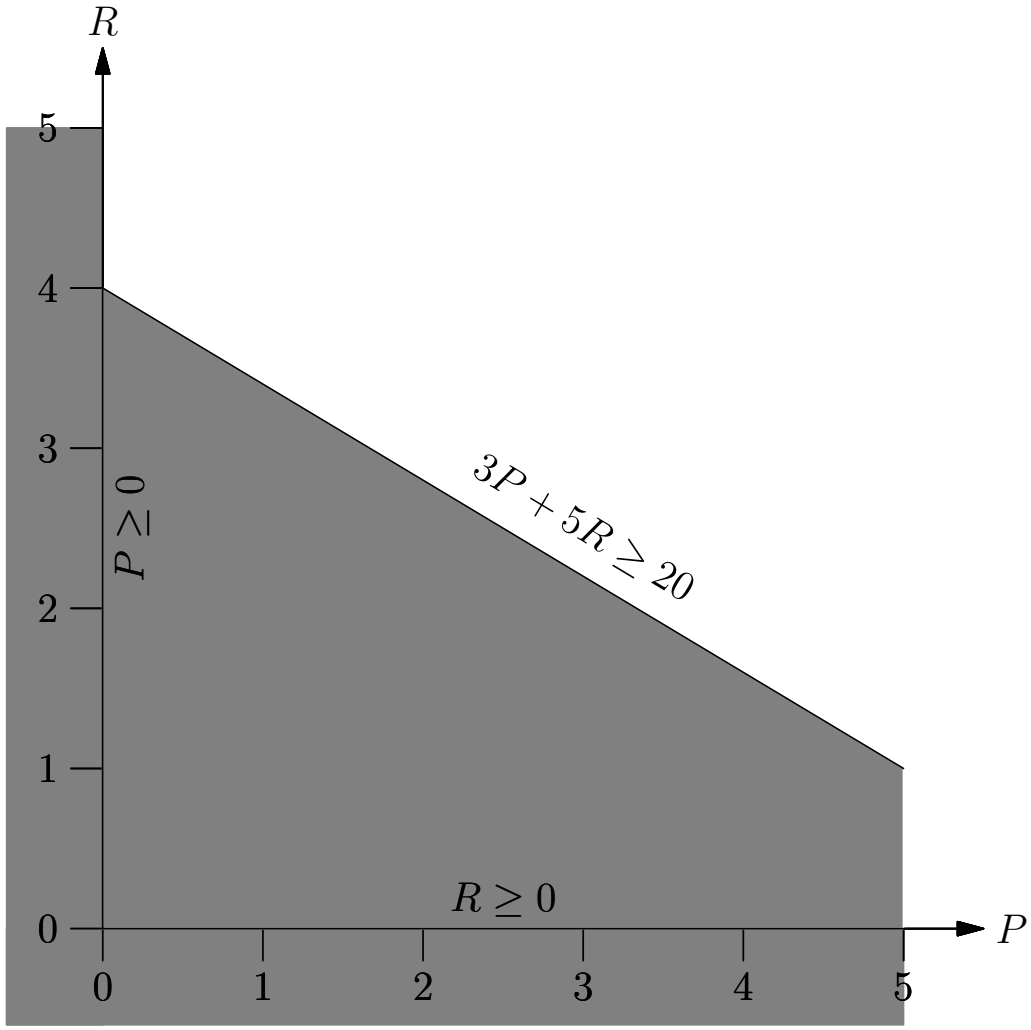
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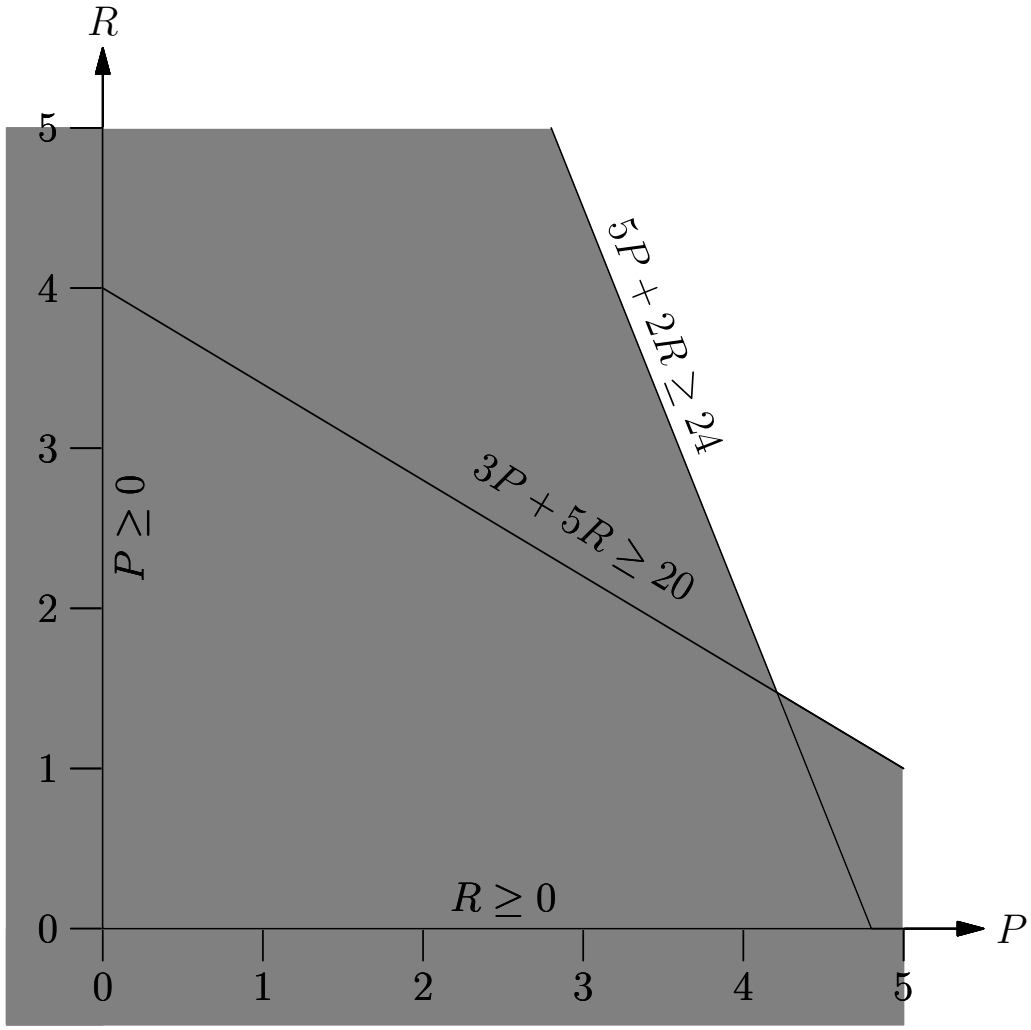
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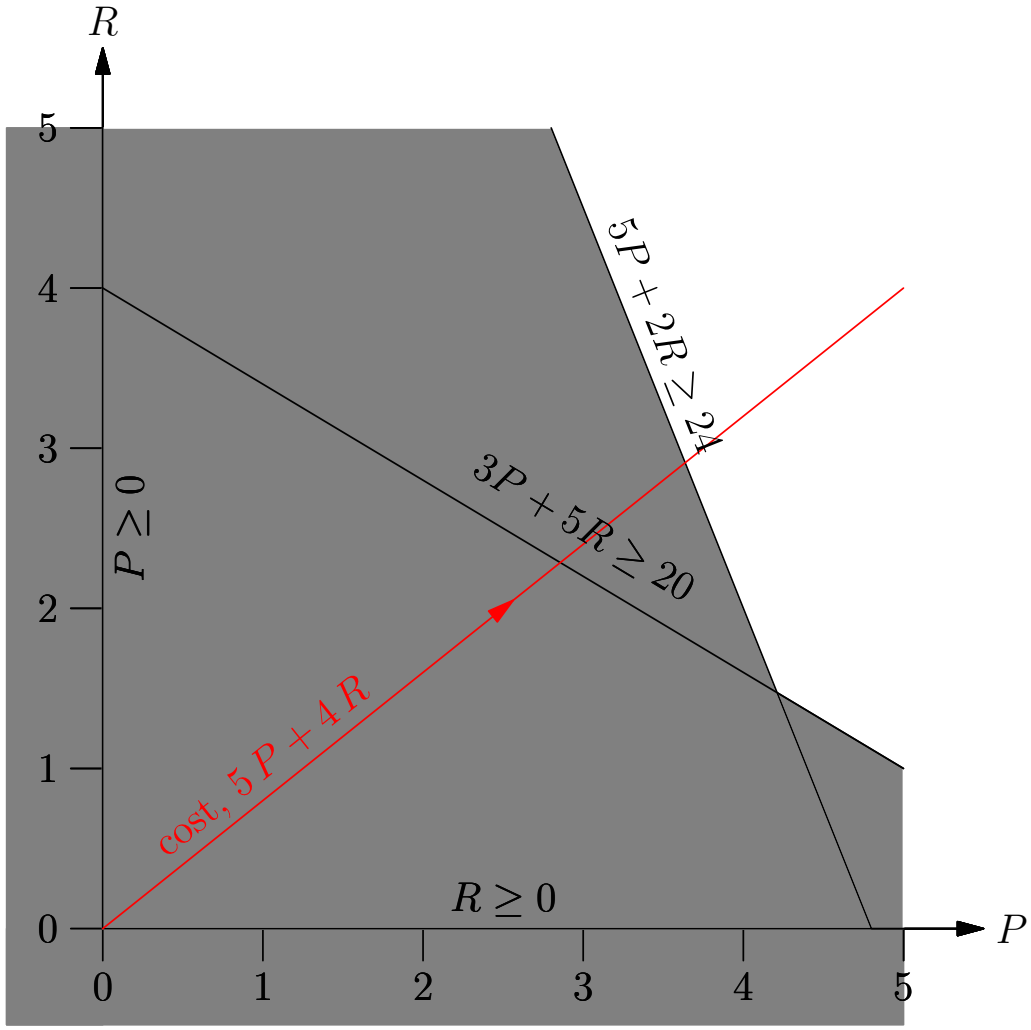
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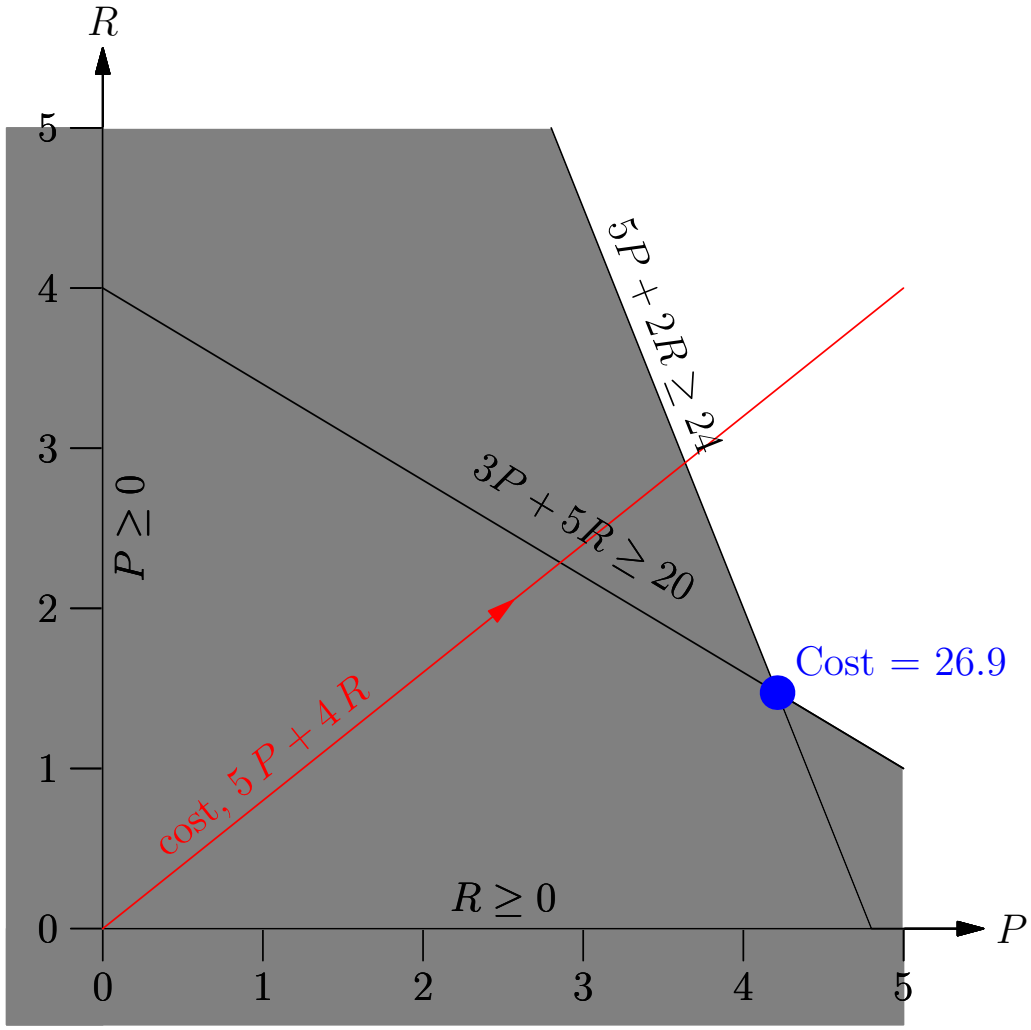
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Lagrangian

- We can write the problem as a Lagrange problem

$$\min_{P,R}\max_{A,C} \quad 5P + 4R - A(3P + 5R - 20) - C(5P + 2R - 24)$$

- subject to $P,R,A,C \geq 0$
- A and C are Lagrange multipliers for vitamin A and C
- We can rearrange the Lagrangian to obtain

$$\max_{A,C}\min_{P,R} \quad 20A + 24C - P(3A + 5C - 5) - R(5A + 2C - 4)$$

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Dual Problem

- The Lagrangian

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leads to the dual problem

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$$\text{subject to} \quad 3A + 5C \leq 5 \quad 5A + 2C \leq 4 \quad A, C \geq 0$$

- Consider someone selling vitamins A and C. They want to maximise the price of vitamins A and C, but their prices cannot exceed the price of the vitamins in potatoes or rice

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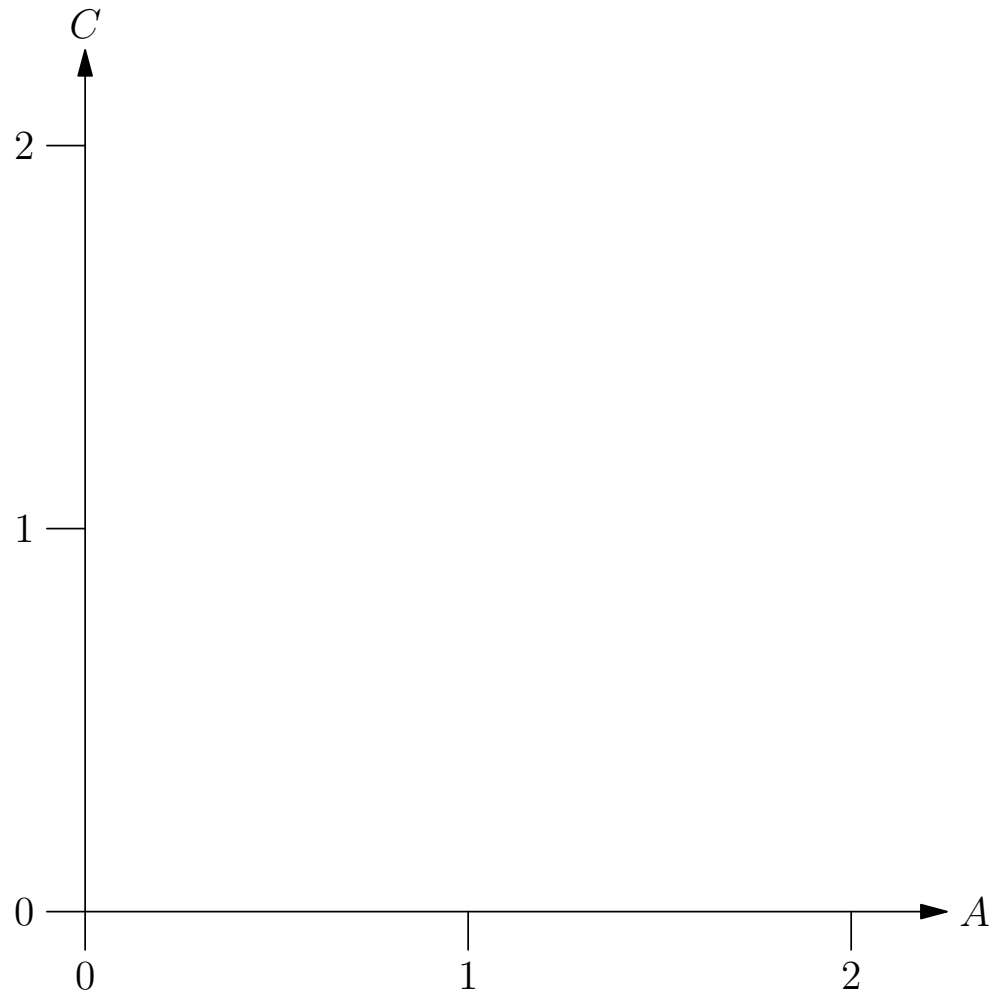
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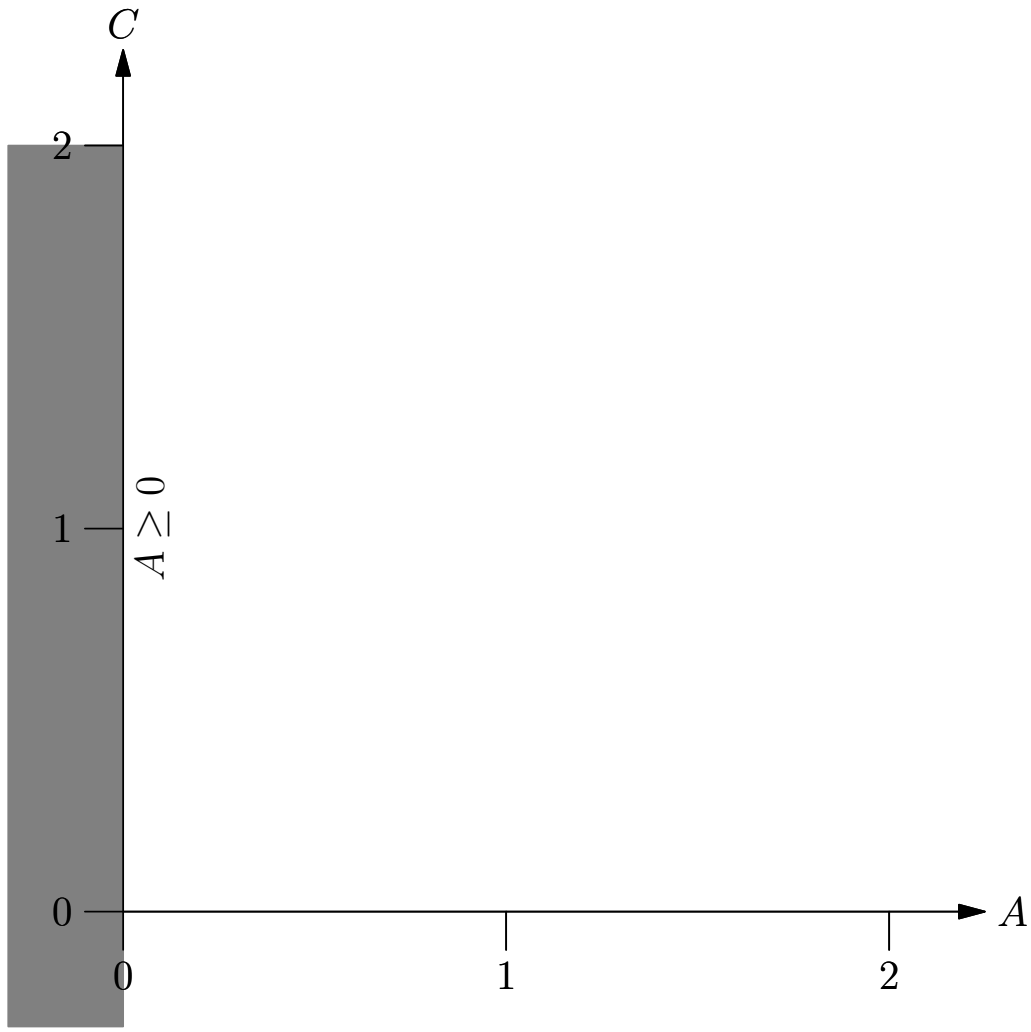
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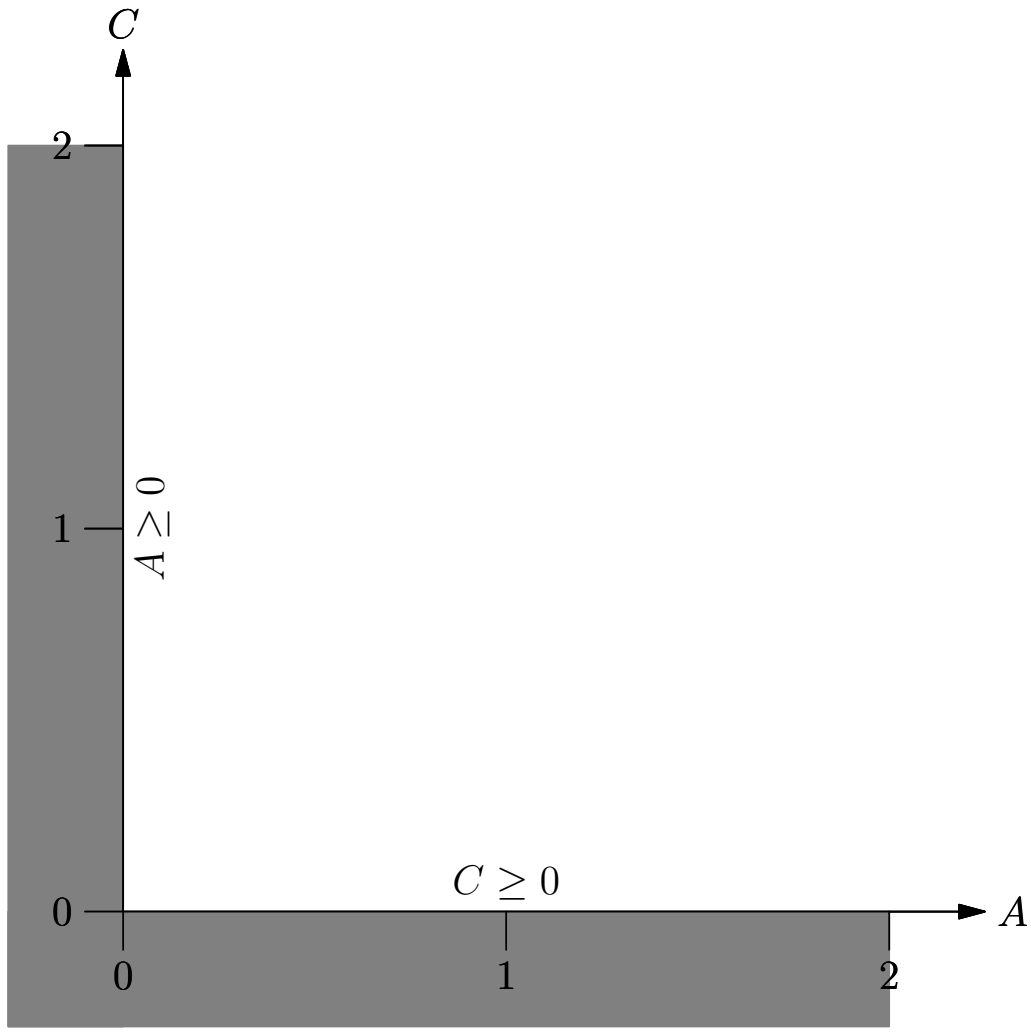
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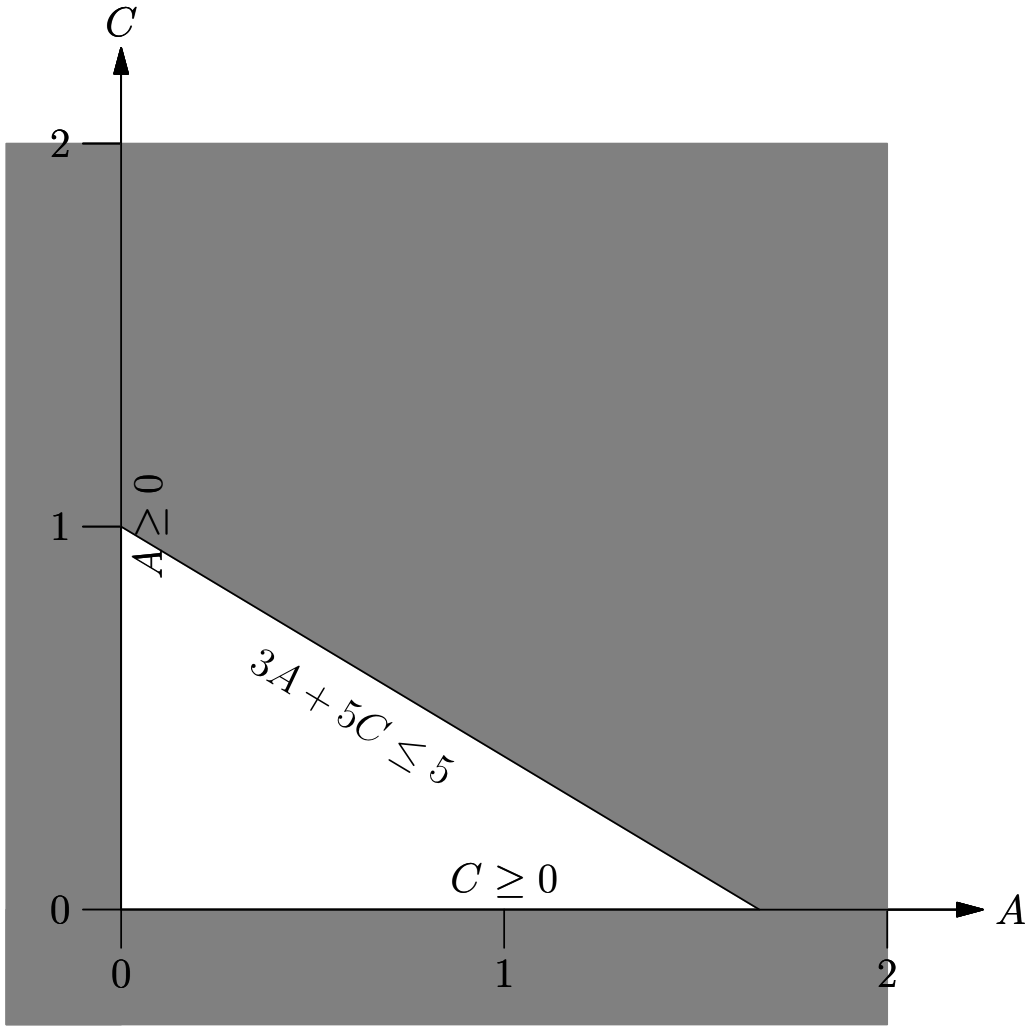
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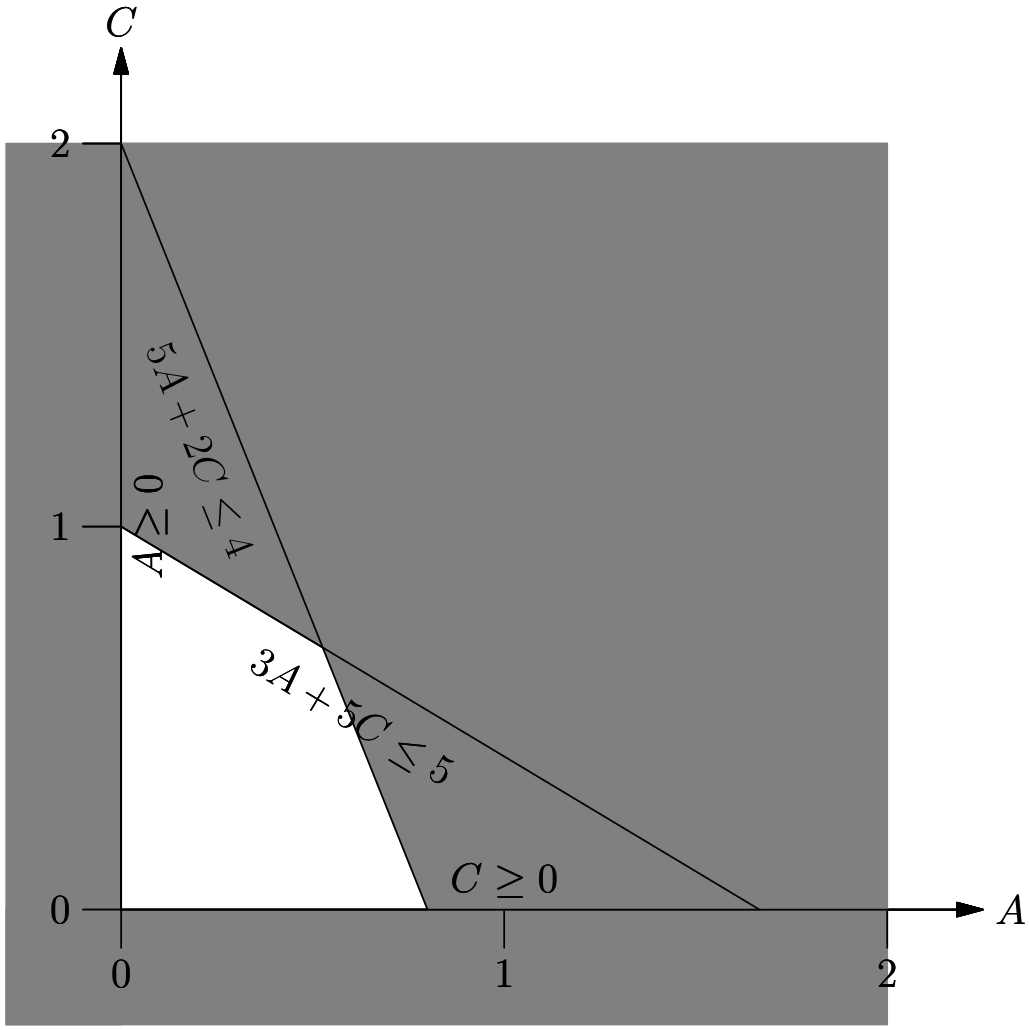
Dual Linear Programme

- Maximise $20A + 24C$
- Subject to
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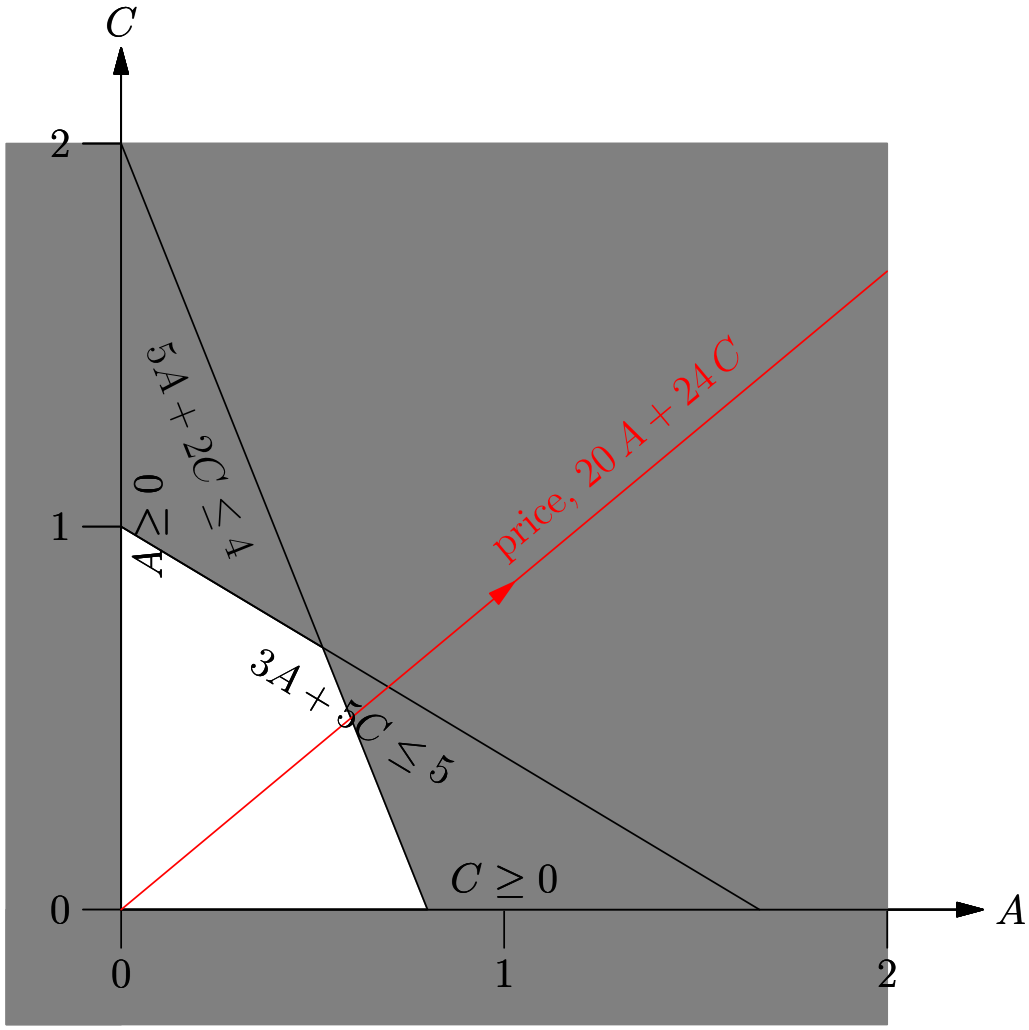
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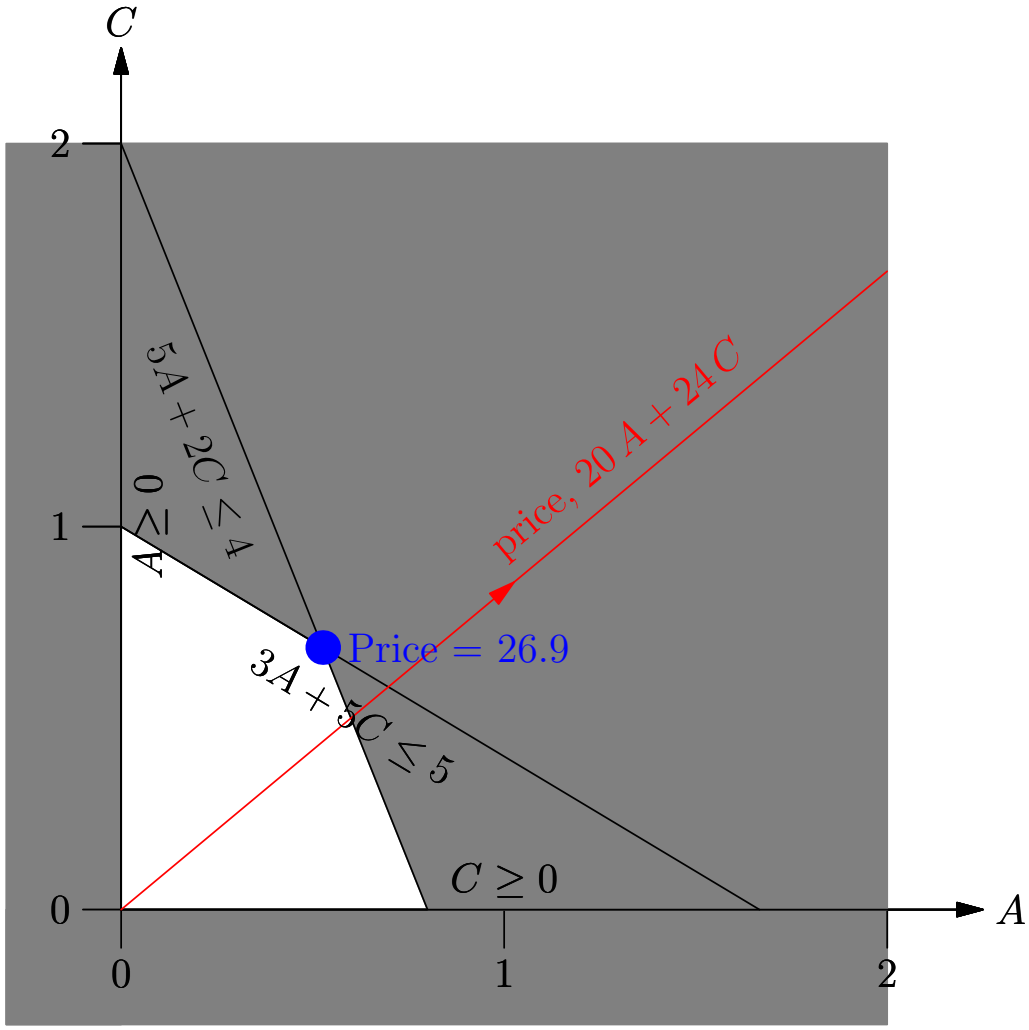
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- Why are we bothered about translating one linear programme into another?
- Sometimes one form is massively easier to solve than the other
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- This is important, for example, in Wasserstein GANs

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Quadratic Programming

- A quadratic programme involves minimising a quadratic function $\boldsymbol{x}^\mathsf{T}\mathbf{Q}\boldsymbol{x}$ (with $\mathbf{Q} \succ 0$) subject to linear constraints $\mathbf{M}\boldsymbol{x} = \boldsymbol{b}$ (or $\mathbf{M}\boldsymbol{x} \geq \boldsymbol{b}$)

- We can define the Lagrangian

$$\mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{x}, \boldsymbol{\alpha}) = \boldsymbol{x}^\mathsf{T}\mathbf{Q}\boldsymbol{x} - \boldsymbol{\alpha}^\mathsf{T}(\mathbf{M}\boldsymbol{x} - \boldsymbol{b})$$

- Where the solution is given by $\max_{\boldsymbol{\alpha}} \min_{\boldsymbol{x}} \mathcal{L}(\boldsymbol{x}, \boldsymbol{\alpha})$

- If the constraints are inequality constraints then $\alpha_i \geq 0$

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Lessons

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- This is particularly useful for problems with unique solutions (it will work when there are multiple solutions, but finding many saddle points is a pain)
- For inequality constraints we need to satisfy KKT conditions
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